

Shaky Neighbour

The repeated terror attacks in Pakistan have left it with a tarnished image, something that will take decades to rebuild ("The Crimson Tide", April 13). It is indeed sad that people who preach Islam often use it to satisfy their own interests, not bothering to think what effect it will have on the lives of innocent people and the minds of millions of children who are growing up with horrifying images of death and destruction in this terror-stricken land.

ARYA CHAKRABORTI,
Chennai

The Peacemaker

It is astonishing that Pervez Musharraf who planned to detach Kashmir from India by planning the Kargil war did not hesitate to come to the India Today Conclave to talk peace ("Challenges of Change", March 23). It was a great achievement for the magazine to be able to rope in people like him.

B.C. HOTA,
Bolangir

Cleaning Up

Justice Verma's appeal to political parties not to field tainted persons as candidates is timely and deserves action at least by the major parties ("The Clean Movement", April 13). It is also time we looked into some other dangerous trends creeping into our system. The proliferation of political parties, about a

thousand in number now, is one. The phenomenon of Rabri Devis and Golma Devis is another. And so is the distortion of having surrogate chief ministers and prime ministers.

S.N. SHARMA,
via www.indiatoday.in

Money Talks

It is gratifying that our aspiring legislators are so well-off ("Wealth Effect", April 20). That poverty, real or simulated, has ceased to be the badge of

huge support from like-thinkers for Jarnail Singh was on expected lines ("Sneaker Attack", April 20). Perhaps in time to come, shoe-hurling will be considered as the most popular weapon to draw the attention of the media and public to demands of aggrieved sections of society, as the shoe-missile managed to hit two birds (Jagdish Tytler and Sajjan Kumar) together.

MADHU AGARWAL,
via www.indiatoday.in



It is no surprise that Narendra Modi is so popular even outside his own state. Looking at his popularity ratings, the secularists will now be calling for his impeachment.

CHANDRAKANT PAREKH, via www.indiatoday.in

nobility in our polity accords with our nationally acquired status of being above the poverty line. Money cannot be isolated from politics but its source must be scrupulously transparent and this must be ensured.

BISHAN SAHAI,
via www.indiatoday.in

Shoe Business

Enormous publicity and

No Child's Play

Ragging seems to be a perennial problem which, despite being prohibited by law, still continues. It will be better if heads of such educational institutions, where these things are reported, are arrested and students involved be debarred from academic life permanently.

V.S. GANESHAN, Bangalore

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

JUNE 1-15, 1979

In Deep Trouble

Troubles, they say, never come singly. And that is what Indira Gandhi, the formidable iron lady of the Emergency, is learning to her cost when her desperate gambles fail one after the other. As she began addressing a restive crowd at Delhi's Ramlila Ground on May 16 to protest against the setting up of Special Courts, workmen began sprucing up Patiala House, a few kilometres away, where the courts are located. The week after she had planned to enter the parliamentary fray in Thanjavur, in the deep south where Indiramma was still supposed to be the favourite of the masses. But by the weekend, she had to beat a hasty retreat as chief minister M.G. Ramachandran of Tamil Nadu had changed his political plans. To add to Mrs Gandhi's woes, her trusted caucus-man, Kalpnath Rai, had put her in a tight spot by eliciting from a reluctant government the sordid details of a pay-off plan involving his leader.



INDIRA
GANDHI

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